

Chapter 89 - Plot

Feng Yue's words were like a thunderclap exploding beside Yan Lin's ears. She could understand every word, but didn't know the meaning behind them.

What did she mean by "that's how it's written in the book"?

She didn't understand what this sentence meant.

When Feng Yue spoke these words, it was like opening some kind of Pandora's box.

"I know you must be very confused, but we really are characters in a book. That book is called 'An Lin's Past'."

The more Yan Lin listened, the more confused she became. She even began to think with her tired brain whether A Yue had been hit in the head by a stone and developed some strange fantasies.

Thinking this way, Yan Lin struggled to sit up straight from Feng Yue's embrace. A Yue's brain already had a tumor—if it had been struck by rocks again, the consequences would be unthinkable.

Seeing Yan Lin pull herself together and sit up straight, Feng Yue understood that she had no choice but to continue with this topic.

Her secret was just a secret, but Yan Lin was a living human life. Moreover, being trapped in this snowy mountain was caused by her in the first place, and even Yan Lin's current high fever was largely due to her. She had to be responsible for Yan Lin's safety.

"A Yue... what are you saying? Are you injured?" Yan Lin propped up her weak body and asked in a hoarse voice.

But Feng Yue didn't look at her. She just sat quietly against the wall, staring straight at the burning candle, then gently shook her head.

"After I died in my previous life, I didn't immediately wake up here. Instead, I went to a very strange place. It was like a sealed room, with blue light emanating from all around, and there was nothing except a book."

"A book?" Yan Lin struggled to understand what Feng Yue meant with her nearly delirious brain.

Feng Yue looked up at her, her expression obscure and difficult to read. "Yes, that book was the 'An Lin's Past' I just mentioned."

Perhaps because Feng Yue's expression was too serious, Yan Lin already believed 80% of what she said. So she asked, "An Lin's Past? An Lin... Lin... Lin is me?"

Seeing Feng Yue nod, Yan Lin frowned. If "Lin" was her, then...

"Who is An?" Yan Lin asked.

"Chu An'an². You should know her." Feng Yue's words were certain and calm, as if she was convinced that Yan Lin definitely knew her.

She actually had no evidence that the two knew each other, but she could guess that after her emotional breakdown that night at the carnival, Yan Lin would definitely investigate what had happened at the carnival.

As long as she investigated this, Chu An'an's figure would definitely appear in Yan Lin's sight.

"Chu An'an..." Yan Lin recalled carefully and suddenly remembered that Mo Yixu had indeed investigated this person's information and given it to her before, but what relationship did she have with this woman?

"A Yue, I do know of her, but we don't know each other..." Yan Lin hurried to explain, then couldn't help coughing violently several times. The coughing was so severe that even the corners of her eyes were misted with moisture.

Feng Yue fed her some water and sighed before continuing: "That book tells the story of you and Chu An'an. Your story takes place in the fourth year after my death, and I'm just a supporting character living in your memories."

"At that time, you remained single, your temperament became unpredictable and taciturn, until you met Chu An'an. You two went through many difficulties together. She saved you, and you changed because of her. You were an enviable couple, admired by everyone, loving each other without doubt..."

Feng Yue thought she no longer cared about this matter, but when she spoke these words again, she still felt that her former self was both pitiful and ridiculous.

After Feng Yue finished speaking, the small storage cabin fell silent except for the raging wind and snow outside.

Yan Lin's confused brain couldn't quickly process such a massive amount of information. She carefully pondered and considered every word and sentence Feng Yue had said.

Feng Yue took a deep breath. The cold air instantly permeated her limbs and bones, clearing her mind considerably. She continued: "I originally thought that as long as I divorced you, as long as I became your ex-wife, I could escape the control of the plot and continue living. But the enormous power of the plot wasn't something I could resist—you and Chu An'an met ahead of schedule."

"Your meeting with her is inevitable, so my death will also be inevitable." Feng Yue's eyes looked at the dancing candlelight, but her gaze wasn't focused on it at all.

"So... that's why you broke down that night, and later made that wish list³ for yourself?" Yan Lin bit her teeth tightly, struggling to endure the dizziness from her brain.

Feng Yue silently acknowledged this.

Yan Lin completely believed everything Feng Yue had said. Since she and Feng Yue could both be reborn, why couldn't they also be characters in a book?

Moreover, only this reason could explain everything Feng Yue had done before.

Only this reason could connect everything together.

"The reason I'm telling you all this isn't because I want you to feel guilty or anything. I just hope you won't fall asleep. Although I'm destined to die, I still don't want us both to be buried in this snowy mountain." Feng Yue paused, then added, "I still have things I want to do..."

Yan Lin felt wave after wave of suffocation in her heart. She had so much she wanted to say to Feng Yue, but her current physical condition didn't allow it.

She was afraid she would speak incoherently and cause more misunderstandings with Feng Yue, so she could only pick the important things to say.

"A Yue... I was reborn from the third year after your death, so I don't know any of what you just said. I haven't met any Chu An'an, and I haven't had any emotional entanglements with her."

At this point, Yan Lin felt her nose tingling with emotion. "After you died, although I still couldn't see my own heart clearly, I can be certain that I would never develop feelings for anyone else."

"You can't sentence me to death because of things I've never done!" Yan Lin almost growled this sentence.

Because her emotions were too intense, she began coughing violently again, this time as if she was going to cough up her lungs.

Feng Yue silently stepped forward to help her breathe, but Yan Lin grabbed her wrist. Her fever-flushed red eyes stared deadly into Feng Yue's eyes.

"A Yue, this isn't fair. You can't sentence me to death because of things in a book. I've never done those things, and I don't even know any Chu An'an."

"After you died, I was always alone—living alone, working alone, eating alone, living alone. Besides you, my life could never accommodate another person."

"At the beginning, I would suffer from insomnia every night. I would wonder why I didn't see you one last time, why I didn't personally receive that letter you wrote. From then on, I developed a habit—I could only sleep peacefully with a lamp beside my bed, and this habit has continued until now⁴."

"Once, after work, my driver was delayed and didn't come. I went to the park to wait for him. I sat on a bench and watched an elderly couple holding hands walk past me. Suddenly I started crying. I didn't know why I was crying or why my heart felt so painful."

"I wanted to find answers to all of this..."

"But my answer had already died."

After saying these words, Yan Lin's grip on Feng Yue's wrist fell weakly, as if speaking these words had exhausted all her strength.

Yan Lin's eye sockets burned hot as she silently lowered her head. Suddenly, a tear fell onto Feng Yue's hand, scalding like fire and making her instinctively flinch.

Feng Yue never knew any of this. She didn't know what those left behind in the world would experience after her death, nor did she know whether they would forget her and choose to create new memories with others.

Yan Lin's words shocked her profoundly, yet she couldn't think of a single word to comfort her.

She had thought that after her death, Yan Lin would continue living normally, just as written in the book, waiting to meet another person she could spend her life with.

But from Yan Lin's words, she was tormented and suffering, yet she didn't even know why she was tormented or suffering.

It was like an incurable ailment—without knowing the source, it couldn't be healed.

Feng Yue didn't know what else to say, and Yan Lin had no remaining strength to speak.

They needed time to digest all of this, so they could only consciously endure and wait in this small storage cabin deep in the snowy mountains.

Feng Yue still allowed Yan Lin to lean on her shoulder. The two of them stayed close together here, like small animals huddling together for warmth.

Feng Yue no longer demanded that Yan Lin speak, because she knew that even if Yan Lin was suffering now, she would have difficulty falling asleep.

Outside the door, the wind and snow continued to howl through the mountain forest. Only the candlelight in this small cabin continued to flicker without extinguishing.

Goose-feather-like snow fell heavily. At the foot of the mountain, three anxious people still sat in the ski resort manager's office.

Jiang Ming had already vented her anger once, and Diana was comforting her while Jiang Zhao was still struggling to negotiate with the resort manager.

"Sir, I understand your urgency, but the snow still shows no sign of diminishing. Even the rescue teams can't operate at this time." The manager wore glasses, and despite the extremely low temperature outside, fine sweat beaded on his forehead.

Jiang Zhao's face was iron-blue. He had made countless phone calls, but every rescue team that understood the situation told him they couldn't act.

Looking at the surveillance footage displayed on the computer screen in front of him, he could easily tell that Feng Yue and Yan Lin had mistakenly entered the wild trail beside the ski resort.

Actually, entering a wild trail wasn't that serious—Yan Lin's skills were superb, so she would definitely bring Feng Yue out successfully. But they had waited at the wild trail exit for a long time without seeing either of them.

From that moment, Jiang Zhao understood that Feng Yue and Yan Lin must have encountered some accident along the way.

The manager tried to comfort him: "Sir, as you said, one of the tourists has rich skiing experience. Our resort has set up a storage cabin in the middle position of this semi-wild trail beside our resort. There's food and water inside. As long as these two can successfully reach the storage cabin, they'll definitely be fine."

Jiang Zhao sighed painfully. He certainly understood this logic, but that was only if the two could "successfully reach" it.

He was afraid that the two had an accident along the way, or that they had never seen the resort's trail distribution map and didn't know about the storage cabin.

Footnotes:

1. "An Lin's Past" (安霖往事) - The title combines "An" from Chu An'an and "Lin" from Yan Lin, indicating their love story
2. Chu An'an - A character who appears to be Yan Lin's destined love interest according to the book/plot
3. Wish list - Referring to the list of things Feng Yue wants to do before she dies, mentioned in earlier chapters
4. The lamp beside the bed - A poignant detail showing how Yan Lin's grief manifested in needing light to sleep, symbolizing her fear of the darkness that came with Feng Yue's absence